



Zoo Explorers

Meet the African Elephant!

Vulnerable

Facts • Colour • Activities

African Elephant Fact File ■

Scientific name:	Loxodonta africana / Loxodonta cyclotis
Status:	Vulnerable
Where they live:	37 countries across Sub-Saharan Africa
Habitat:	Savannas, forests, deserts, and wetlands across Sub-Saharan Africa
Diet:	Herbivore — grasses, leaves, bark, fruit; up to 150 kg of food per day
Weight:	4,000–7,000 kg
Lifespan:	Up to 70 years in the wild
Population:	Around 415,000 (bush); around 100,000 (forest)

Amazing Facts ■

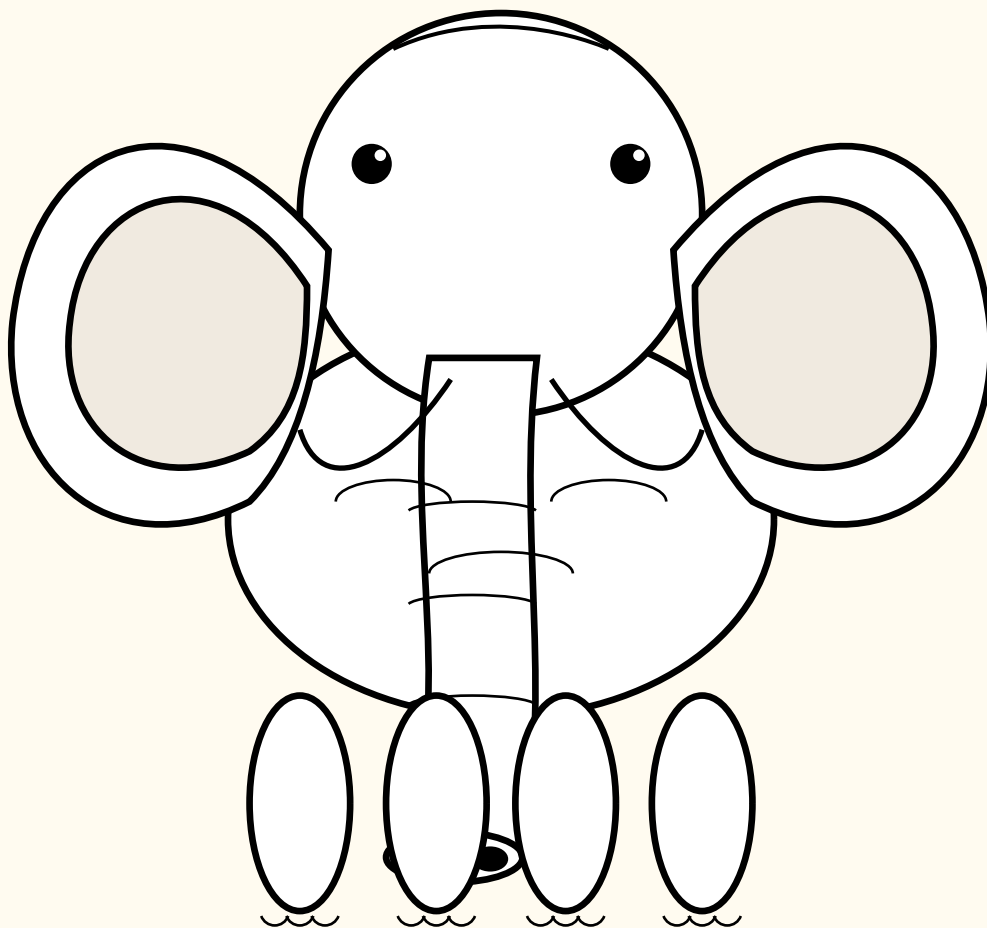
- African elephants are the largest land animals on Earth — a male can weigh 7,000 kg.
- An elephant's trunk is about 2 m long and has around 40,000 muscles.
- They suck up to 7.5 litres of water into their trunk at once, then blow it into their mouth.
- Elephants use their large ears like fans to cool down in the African heat.
- They live in herds led by the oldest female, called the matriarch.
- Elephants are hunted mainly for their ivory tusks — which is illegal worldwide.

Threats ■■

#	Threat	Impact
1	Poaching for ivory tusks	CRITICAL
2	Habitat loss as savannas and forests become farmland	HIGH
3	Human-elephant conflict over crops and water	HIGH
4	Climate change reducing water and food availability	MODERATE

Colour Me! — African Elephant

African elephants are grey with deeply wrinkled skin. Their large fan-shaped ears are lighter underneath.



Activities

Word Search — find all 8 words!

J	F	H	E	E	S	J	B	F	O	G	F
R	E	P	L	I	S	A	D	H	X	D	D
L	H	O	E	E	C	N	V	C	E	E	P
Q	X	A	P	M	S	Z	T	A	R	R	B
C	T	C	H	P	J	R	Y	E	N	V	D
Y	U	H	A	H	E	B	G	I	R	N	A
Z	S	I	N	M	J	N	L	N	N	C	A
I	K	N	T	T	A	P	J	P	I	O	Q
V	Y	G	X	D	W	C	Z	R	O	D	X
O	W	I	N	Z	Y	E	F	X	Z	K	Y
R	P	E	U	W	N	A	H	C	F	G	Q
Y	R	V	K	H	W	O	Z	K	B	R	T

ELEPHANT	IVORY	SAVANNA	ENDANGERED
AFRICA	TUSK	POACHING	HERD

Match It Up!

African Elephant		the female leader of the herd
Tusk		largest land animal
Herd		a family group of elephants
Poaching		illegal hunting for ivory
Matriarch		long ivory tooth

Fill in the Blanks!

- Elephants are the largest _____ animals on Earth.
- They are hunted illegally for their _____ tusks.
- An elephant's trunk has around _____ muscles.
- African elephants can live up to _____ years.

Answers: land | ivory | 40,000 | 70

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